

MINISTRIES DEPARTMENTS AND CENTRAL SECRETARIAT

CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE — AOB AND TOB: JURISDICTION — INSTITUTION MAP: POLITICAL HEAD — MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE — CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND — CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE OPERATING CHAIN

CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE OPERATING CHAIN ROOT QUESTION HOW DOES PARLIAMENTARY EXECUTIVE AUTHORITY BECOME ORGANISED GOVERNMENTAL ACTION? ARTICLES 73 + 74 ---- UNION EXECUTIVE FIELD AND -- POLITICAL AUTHORITY REMAINS CONSTITUTION-BOUNDED

ARTICLE 77 ----- ACTION IN PRESIDENT'S NAME AND AUTHENTICATION

ARTICLE 77(3) BUSINESS-ALLOCATION AND TRANSACTION RULES

ARTICLE 78 ----- PM COMMUNICATION AND INFORMATION DUTIES TO

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ROOT QUESTION
- How does parliamentary executive authority become organised governmental action?

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ARTICLES 73 + 74 ---- Union executive field and ministerial advice
- political authority remains Constitution-bounded

CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 77 ----- action in President's name and authentication
- Article 77(3) business-allocation and transaction rules

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 78 ----- PM communication and information duties to President
- Ministerial direction → Secretariat advice/process → agency delivery → accountability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A ministry joins democratic authority, ministerial responsibility and permanent expertise, while its effectiveness depends on aligning policy, finance, personnel, coordination and accountability.

01

STAGE 01 AOB AND TOB: JURISDICTION BEFORE PROCEDURE

AOB AND TOB JURISDICTION BEFORE PROCEDURE ARTICLE 77(3) ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES WHO TRAP RAIL ARTICLE 309 SCHEDULE CAN CHANGE STATUTE STILL CONTROLS.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
ARTICLE 77(3)
ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES who handles what how a proposal is decided ministry/department +
subjects disposal + consultation + escalation lawful owner + lawful decision route

POWER / PROCEDURE
TRAP RAIL
AoB != ToB
both != Article 309

CHECK / LIMIT
schedule can change
statute still controls.
ANSWER STRIP

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 77(3)
- ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES who handles what how a proposal is decided ministry/department +
- subjects disposal + consultation + escalation lawful owner + lawful decision route

POWER / PROCEDURE

- TRAP RAIL
- AoB != ToB
- both != Article 309

CHECK / LIMIT

- schedule can change
- statute still controls.
- ANSWER STRIP

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Articles 74, 75, 77 and 88 connect advice, responsibility, business rules and parliamentary participation, thereby linking Union administration to democratic accountability.

02

STAGE 02 INSTITUTION MAP: POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY

INSTITUTION MAP POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY SECRETARIAT POLITICAL BROAD ALLOCATED POLICY/LAW/BUDGET CHARGE UNIT SUBJECT UNIT ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE TECHNICAL LEAD EXECUTION/SERVICE TERRITORIAL SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS STATUTORY BODY
AUTONOMOUS BODY TRAP ADMINISTRATIVE ASSOCIATION DOES NOT ERASE THE SOURCE INSTRUMENT

PORTFOLIO — MINISTRY — DEPARTMENT — SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit

ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain → SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body → autonomous body

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory
ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain

POWER / PROCEDURE
SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body
autonomous body

CHECK / LIMIT
TRAP administrative association does not erase the source instrument or statutory independence.
PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain
SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The delivery chain runs from ministerial policy through Secretariat coordination to directorates and field agencies, while feedback and accountability must travel back upward.

03

STAGE 03 MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE AND SECRETARY

MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE AND SECRETARY POLITICAL EXECUTIVE CABINET MINISTER PORTFOLIO LEADERSHIP, CABINET PARTICIPATION, PARLIAMENT. MINISTER OF STATE INDEPENDENT CHARGE OR ASSIGNED ASSISTANCE, AS FORMALLY ALLOCATED. PERMANENT EXECUTIVE
ADMINISTRATIVE HEAD + PRINCIPAL OFFICIAL ADVISER + TRANSACTION COMPLIANCE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
POLITICAL EXECUTIVE
Cabinet Minister → portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament.
Minister of State → independent charge or assigned assistance, as formally allocated.
PERMANENT EXECUTIVE

POWER / PROCEDURE
Secretary → administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance.
PRODUCTIVE RELATION elected priority → candid options/legality → recorded decision → loyal implementation.
FAILURE BRANCHES politicised advice
bureaucratic veto

CHECK / LIMIT
oral direction
short tenure
hidden responsibility.
ANSWER STRIP

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- POLITICAL EXECUTIVE
- Cabinet Minister → portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament.
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- PERMANENT EXECUTIVE

- Secretary → administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance.
- PRODUCTIVE RELATION elected priority → candid options/legality → recorded decision → loyal implementation.
- FAILURE BRANCHES politicised advice
- bureaucratic veto

- oral direction
- short tenure
- hidden responsibility.
- ANSWER STRIP

- Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Cabinet makes collective political decisions, Cabinet Committees handle delegated political work, and Committees of Secretaries coordinate administration without acquiring ministerial authority.

04

STAGE 04 CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS CENTRAL SECRETARIAT POLICY FILE RAIL RECEIPT SECTION EXAMINATION INTER-DEPARTMENT CONSULTATION DELEGATED OR HIGHER APPROVAL SECTION OFFICER UNDER SECRETARY

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy → FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options → inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval → authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTL → Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy
FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options

POWER / PROCEDURE
inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval
authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTL

CHECK / LIMIT
Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director
Joint Secretary → Additional/Special Secretary → Secretary.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
TRAP not every file reaches Minister/Secretary; delegation is an accountability design, not evasion.
CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Central Secretariat is the collective policy-support machinery of Union ministries, not a single building and not a synonym for the Cabinet Secretariat.

05

STAGE 05 CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION

CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION CABINET SECRETARIAT CABINET PAPERS/DECISIONS AOB-TOB ADMINISTRATION CRISIS AND CONSENSUS. PMO DIRECT ASSISTANCE TO PRIME MINISTER PRIORITY REVIEW MATTERS REQUIRING PM ATTENTION.

Cabinet papers/decisions
PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister
Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet

AoB-ToB administration
priority review
PMO != super-ministry

CoS
matters requiring PM attention.
Cabinet Secretary != minister.

crisis and consensus.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CABINET SECRETARIAT
- Cabinet papers/decisions
- AoB-ToB administration
- crisis and consensus.

POWER / PROCEDURE
PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister
priority review
matters requiring PM attention.
UNRESOLVED DIFFERENCE department consultation → Committee of Secretaries → concerned ministers

CHECK / LIMIT
Cabinet Committee/Cabinet under the prescribed route.
Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet
PMO != super-ministry
Cabinet Secretary != minister.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ANSWER STRIP
Central coordination should enable departments without erasing ministerial answerability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Over-centralisation in either can weaken departmental initiative; weak central coordination can produce silos and contradictory policies.

06

STAGE 06 AGENCIES, AUTONOMY AND WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT OUTCOMES

AGENCIES, AUTONOMY AND WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT OUTCOMES DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER ATTACHED/SUBORDINATE OFFICE TECHNICAL/FIELD EXECUTION AUTONOMOUS BODY CHARTERED SPECIAL FUNCTION COMMERCIAL/STRATEGIC OPERATION REGULATOR
STATUTE-BASED ARM'S-LENGTH GOVERNANCE WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM CLIMATE/DATA/SKILLS/WATER MANY DEPARTMENTS

DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance → WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure. → CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function
CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance

POWER / PROCEDURE
WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.
CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.

CHECK / LIMIT
LIMIT mission unit or dashboard cannot displace statute, sanction, Cabinet route or audit.
DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance
WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Secretariats primarily formulate and supervise policy while executive agencies deliver it, but delegation never removes departmental stewardship or ministerial accountability.

07

STAGE 07 OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE

OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE ACCOUNTABILITY GRID POLITICAL AND POLICY SCRUTINY. FINANCIAL LEGALITY, PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE. TRANSPARENCY, LEGALITY AND PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY. 2ND ARC PRINCIPLES COMPETENCY-TO-POST FIT
MISSION KARMA YOGI DIGITAL RECORD

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
ACCOUNTABILITY GRID
Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny.
budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance.

POWER / PROCEDURE
RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.
2nd ARC principles
competency-to-post fit

CHECK / LIMIT
Mission Karma Yogi digital record
impact evaluation
stable tenure

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
specialist/lateral support.
Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.
TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ACCOUNTABILITY GRID
- Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny.
- budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance.

- RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.
- 2nd ARC principles
- competency-to-post fit

- Mission Karma Yogi digital record
- impact evaluation
- stable tenure

- specialist/lateral support.
- Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.
- TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Preserve institutional balance: coordination by Cabinet Secretariat/PMO must enable, not erase, ministerial responsibility and departmental expertise.

08

STAGE 08 UPSC SYNTHESIS: ORGANISED AUTHORITY WITH TRACEABLE RESPONSIBILITY

UPSC SYNTHESIS ORGANISED AUTHORITY WITH TRACEABLE RESPONSIBILITY PRELIMS FIREWALL PRESIDENT'S NAME PERSONAL DECISION CABINET SECRETARIAT CABINET COMMITTEE COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES ATTACHED OFFICE

PRELIMS FIREWALL → President's name != personal decision → Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat → Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries attached office → regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PRELIMS FIREWALL
- President's name != personal decision
- Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat

POWER / PROCEDURE
Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries attached office != autonomous body
regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction.
MAINS SPINE

CHECK / LIMIT
Articles 73/74/77/78 → AoB-ToB → ministry/department
Minister-Secretary → Secretariat/file → coordination
agencies/outcomes → oversight → reform.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
PVQ SPINE
2025 organisation-ministry pairs → verify allocated subject and parent law.
VERDICT effective machinery aligns functions, funds, functionaries, expertise and answerability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Executive action is taken in the President's name, but the President does not personally administer each department.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT THE PRINCIPAL DELEGATES AUTHORITY THE AGENT POSSESSES INFORMATION THE PRINCIPAL MAY LACK MONITORING IS INCOMPLETE; AND RESPONSIBILITY CAN BE SHIFTED DOWN OR SIDWAYS. ADVERSE SELECTION
APPOINTING AN AGENT WITHOUT KNOWING CAPABILITY/INTEGRITY MORAL HAZARD

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- the principal delegates authority;
- the agent possesses information the principal may lack;
- monitoring is incomplete; and
- responsibility can be shifted down or sideways.

ADVANCED LIMIT

- adverse selection: appointing an agent without knowing capability/integrity;
- moral hazard: agent acts differently after receiving discretion;
- information asymmetry: ministry/agency knows more than Parliament/citizen;
- multiple principals: an agency answers to ministry, finance, regulator, court and legislature;

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- blame avoidance: success is claimed centrally while failure is attributed to field offices.
- Minister states objectives, political priorities and acceptable trade-offs.
- Secretary supplies options, legality, evidence, implementation constraints and institutional
- Disagreement is recorded professionally.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.